

Bhagvatiben Ajitsingh Vaghela, 43

Bhesana, Mahesana, Gujarat

What makes her a water warrior: In Bhesana village, Mahesana, Bhagvatiben Ajitsingh Vaghela has pioneered a **data-driven groundwater conservation** model. As a **BhujalJankar,** she meticulously tracks 55 wells, 120 households, and 700 hectares of land, using this data to design water-saving strategies. She identified desilting needs, tackled high TDS levels, and championed artificial recharge measures. Leading 500 villagers, she promoted drip irrigation, alternate furrow techniques, and intercropping, transforming water usage in agriculture. Presenting annual water budgets, she bridges data with action, proving that grassroots leadership and informed planning can make Bhesana water-secure for future generations.

Veena LP, 43

Timmanayakanakote, Chitradurga, Karnataka

What makes her a water warrior: Veena LP, a farmer's daughter turned groundwater crusader, has transformed water management in her village. As a **Community Resource Person** under Atal Bhujal Yojana, she launched door-to-door campaigns, urging farmers to adopt micro-irrigation and groundwater monitoring. Leading by example, she installed a sprinkler system on her farm and convinced 50 farmers to follow suit. She introduced water flow meters, static water level monitoring, and a community data board, making water usage transparent. Once resistant, farmers now seek her advice, proving that one informed voice can inspire a village to secure its water future.





Abhishek Chopra, 43

Niwarsi, Kurukshetra, Haryana

What makes him a water warrior: Abhishek Chopra is revolutionizing paddy farming in Haryana by pioneering the **Direct Seeded Rice (DSR) technique**, drastically cutting water use on his 45-acre farm while maintaining high yields. By eliminating the Puddle Transplanted Rice (PTR) method, he has proven DSR's necessity for groundwater conservation. Using water flow meters, precise irrigation, herbicide control, and strategic fertilization, he has set a benchmark for sustainable agriculture. His success has gained recognition from policymakers, inspiring neighboring farmers to adopt water-efficient methods. In a region plagued by water stress, Chopra's approach ensures every drop counts, securing Haryana's water future.